League. It was a large cabinet of forty-two. Many ministers were known to be corrupt. There was, however, no place for the pro-Chinese Awami League group, which has seventy-six seats in the Parliament. While the cabinet formation was a fiasco, there was another even more significant development—complete disagreement between Sattar and BNP men about the Vice President position. Against the views of many of his followers, Sattar decided to appoint a political non-entity, Mirza Nurul Huda, as Vice President. The next three months—November 1981 to January 1982—in fact, saw continuous fighting in the BNP between the left wing anticorruption group and the Prime Minister's faction. This was compounded by an unseemly controversy about Zia's widow Begum Khaleda Zia in connection with the election to the post of president of the party. She was offered the post by Sattar, who, however, backed out of the commitment in midJanuary, obviously under the Prime Minister's pressure. Begum Zia came out into the open, asking for a more balanced cabinet. Parallel to these developments in the ruling party, there was a controversy between the army and the President. Ershad put forward a formal claim for participation in the government and also criticised the corrupt elements in the cabinet. He demanded a presidential advisory group. Sattar responded by having a National Security Council in which the service chiefs would be in minority of three in a group of ten. This was publicly rejected by the army which resulted in a stalemate. Unable to govern with the corrupt cabinet, Sattar went back to the dissident leaders, promising reform on 13 February. The cabinet was dismissed and a much smaller Cabinet of eighteen people was sworn in. The immediate reason was to prevent a boycott of the president's speech in Parliament on 15 February. He also gave in to the army by dismissing the old Security Council and appointing a new one of six members, consisting of three